Kiran Vargaonkar

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PROFILE

Early-career researcher and environmental professional with experience in climate adaptation policy, environmental compliance, and sustainability within government, academia, and industry. Interested in teaching and interdisciplinary research at the intersection of climate resilience, environmental governance, and behavioural responses to climate risk.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Climate resilience and coastal sustainability
- Illegal sand mining and coastal geomorphology
- Environmental governance and natural resource management
- Remote sensing, GIS, and geospatial environmental monitoring
- Community-based climate adaptation and disaster risk reduction
- Environmental policy and evidence-based decision making

EDUCATION

Dublin City University (DCU) Business School - Dublin, Ireland

MSc in **Business Management** | First Class Honours, Ranked 5th in Class | Oct 2023

- ***Dissertation*****:** Comparative evaluation of international expansion strategies using quantitative research, institutional analysis, and evidence-based policy evaluation.
- *Relevant coursework:* Research Methods, Quantitative Methods, Sustainability Strategy, Data Analysis, Crisis Management, Policy Evaluation.

University of Mumbai - Mumbai, India

Bachelor of Engineering in **Mechanical Engineering** | Nov 2016

- Final-year project: Solar thermal desalination system for rural water applications.

Tianjin University of Technology - China

3 Week Winter Student Exchange Program, Chinese Language and Culture | Jan 2019

- Selected for a fully funded three-week international exchange programme in Tianjin and Beijing, focusing on Chinese language, culture, and cross-cultural engagement.

PUBLICATIONS / REPORTS

- Contributor, *Working Group 3 Report: Resilient Decision-Making* , Climate Ireland Adaptation Network (CIAN), EPA Ireland, 2026
- Contributor, *Working Group 4 Report: Resilience Indicator Development* , Climate Ireland Adaptation Network (CIAN), EPA Ireland, 2026

RESEARCH & POLICY EXPERIENCE

Climate Ireland Adaptation Network (CIAN), Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) - Ireland
Contributed to Working Groups on **Resilient Decision-Making** and **Resilience Indicator Development**.

- Collaborated with researchers, policymakers, local authorities, and industry to develop climate resilience indicators integrating behavioural, institutional, and socio-economic dimensions.
- Contributed to interdisciplinary research on climate resilience indicators, supporting evidence-based recommendations for Ireland's national climate adaptation strategy.

Project Management Institute (PMI)
NextGen Outreach Team | Jan 2023 - Dec 2024

- Analysed youth engagement patterns to inform strategy design and outreach initiatives targeting early-career professionals
- Contributed to the development of research-informed outreach programmes, integrating insights from market research and stakeholder feedback

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- **Global Citizen Scholarship Program**, **Ban Ki-moon Foundation,** *India (2026)* - Selected as one of *17 Global Citizen Leaders*; awarded seed funding to implement a community-based climate resilience project focused on post-flood preparedness and recovery.
- **Sustainability Leaders Programme**, **Climate Ready Academy**, *Ireland (2025)* - Competitively selected as one of **20 professionals nationwide** for a **fully funded eight-week** sustainability leadership programme supported by **Uisce Éireann (Irish Water)**.
- **Advanced Water Stewardship Programme**, **20FIFTY Partners & Uisce Éireann (Irish Water)**, *Ireland (2025)* - Selected for a **fully funded eight-week** professional programme in sustainable water stewardship, water risk, and resource management.
- **Winter Programme in Chinese Language & Culture**, **Tianjin University of Technology**, *China (2019)* - Awarded a **fully funded three-week** international exchange programme in **Tianjin and Beijing**, focusing on Chinese language, culture, and cross-cultural engagement.
- **Asia Student Summit**, *South Korea (2018)* - Selected from **3,041 applicants** across Asia for a **fully funded seven-day** leadership summit in **Seoul**, focusing on education, international collaboration, and sustainable development.

LANGUAGES

- English
- Marathi
- Hindi
- Malvani
- Konkani
- Mandarin

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

MSD Ireland, Biologics Manufacturing Site - Meath, Ireland
Associate EHS | Sep 2024 - Dec 2025
EHS Intern | Jun 2024 - Aug 2024

- Developed a five-year Biodiversity Action Plan and contributed to site-wide environmental initiatives.
- Conducted environmental risk assessments, regulatory compliance monitoring, and incident investigations within a GMP-regulated pharmaceutical facility.
- Supported EPA, HSA, and Irish Water compliance, sustainability reporting, and CAPA implementation.

The Disney Store Limited - Dublin, Ireland
Cast Member | Dec 2022 - May 2024

- Delivered excellent customer service and achieved an upselling rate of over 80%, contributing to store revenue targets.
- Strengthened communication, stakeholder engagement, and problem-solving skills.

IAM Private Limited - Mumbai, India
Project Manager | Dec 2019 - Apr 2022

- Managed multidisciplinary engineering projects involving risk management, compliance, stakeholder engagement, and project evaluation.

Zicom SaaS Private Limited - Mumbai, India
Project Coordinator | Aug 2017 - Dec 2019

- Coordinated large-scale engineering projects, project reporting, and stakeholder communication.